

One Million Experience Draft

Resource to collect

Threads: Represents evidence, leads and understanding of the conspiracy.

Context

Set in a medieval era, you play as the sworn knight of Princess Elvira. A situation has unfolded and you set out to find out the truth to protect the princess from harm.

Design:

Hygiene throughout the city heavily reflects the harsh realities of the era.

Residents of Merchant's Row and The Dregs can't afford for private plumbing, forcing them to use shared communal toilets.

Near the borders of The Dregs, locals must dispose of waste in open communal cesspits due to lack of proper sewage systems.

Conversely, sanitation improves alongside wealth. The closer a one lives to the High District, the more affluent they are, allowing for private, working toilets inside their homes.

Map Layout

Level 0:

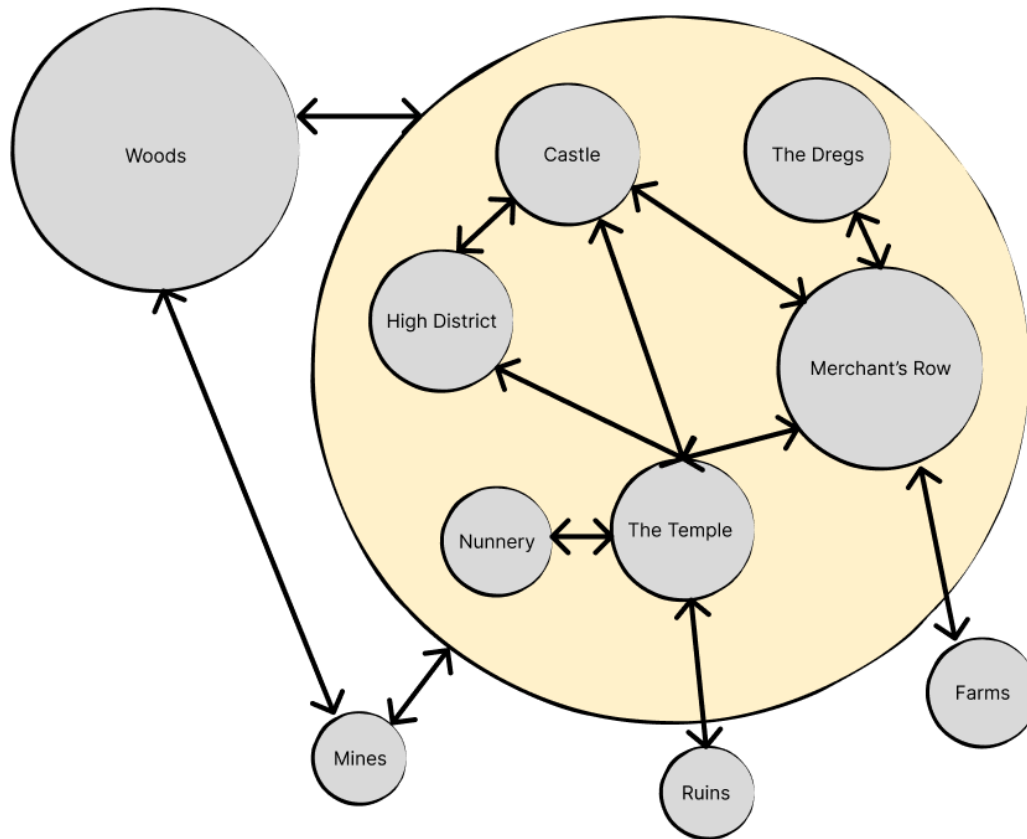


Other Levels: Basement and Upper



Programme:

Overall Programme



Objectives

Main Objective: To uncover the conspiracy against the Crown and save Princess Elvira from the assassination attempt during her coronation.

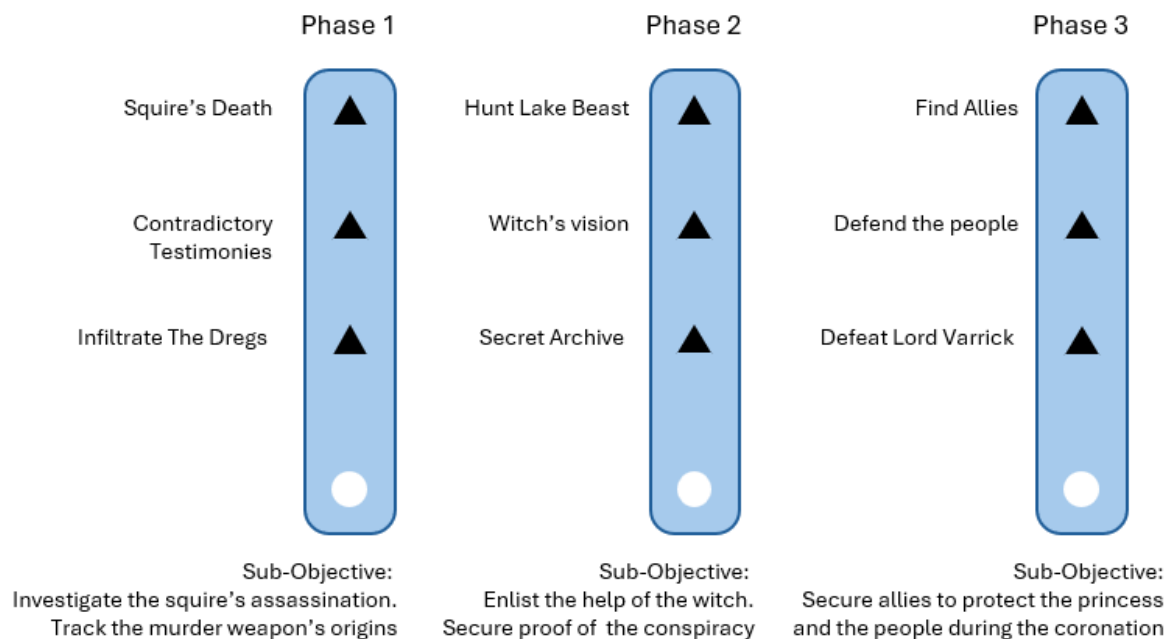
Sub Objective: Driving goals for each part of the quest

- Part 1: The Squire
 - Investigate the assassination of your squire by examining the evidence (the arrow, doubloon, and letter fragment) on his body.
- Part 2: Official Investigation
 - Gather witness statements from the castle guards, servants, and nobles, and identify contradictions to reveal an internal cover-up.
- Part 3: Merchant's Row
 - Identify which groups are connected to the assassin's arrow by questioning the legitimate city guilds.
- Part 4: Into The Dregs
 - Go undercover to gather intel on the Black Hounds and confirm the plot against the coronation.
- Part 5: The Black Hounds
 - Infiltrate the mercenary headquarters to confirm the source of the arrow and locate the Witch's whereabouts.
- Part 6: The Witch
 - Enlist the Witch's help. Hunt the lake beast to prove your resolve.
- Part 7: Secrets
 - Explore the ruins and solve the archive contraption to uncover proof of the conspiracy against the Crown.
- Part 8: An Unlikely Alliance
 - Help clear the Black Hounds' name and enlist their help as an ally for the upcoming ceremony.
- Part 9: Coronation
 - Defend Princess Elvira from the conspirators, protect the fleeing citizens from the beasts, and defeat Lord Varrick in his final demonic form to secure the throne.

#	Name	Details	Duration	Intensity
1	Intro	Speak to the frantic squire, he is assassinated mid-sentence to you.	2 min	5
2	The Body	Inspect the squire's body. Retrieve the arrow, a letter fragment, and a doubloon.	2 min	2
3	Archer	Examine the surrounding courtyard to identify where the archer shot from.	2 min	2
4	Orders	Speak to Princess Elvira to report the death and situation. Receive your orders.	1 min	3
5	Servants	Question the castle guards and servants to take statements.	3 min	1
6	Nobles	Question the nobles present, compare conflicting statements. There is a coverup.	2 min	3
7	Guilds	Visit The Golden balance and The Aegis Exchange. No information of use, refusal help a knight.	4 min	1
8	Gossip	Visit a tavern for a drink. Overhear conversations amongst mercenaries. Option to bribe them for information.	2 min	2
9	Peddler	Approach the suspicious peddler in the alley. Bribe him for some information	2 min	2
10	Disguise	Ditch your equipment and don a cloak. Enter The Dregs.	1 min	1
11	Eavesdrop	Snake through the tavern and blend in. Eavesdrop on conversations to confirm the Black Hounds' involvement.	3 min	4
12	Retreat	Sneak out the tavern without rousing suspicion. Optional: Combat encounter if caught/tried to bribe.	4 min	5
13	Black Hounds	Break into the Black Hounds' headquarters without alerting anyone.	2 min	4
14	Armoury	Investigate and discover guild issued arrow.	2 min	3
15	Receptionist	Sneak into the guild front and speak to the receptionist. Bribe or threaten her to receive information regarding the magic sigils on the arrow you have	2 min	4
16	Combat	Black Hounds are alerted of suspicious individual, combat starts, stopping you from escaping.	2 min	6
17	Woods	Travel through the Whispering Woods fighting beasts and solve environmental pathing puzzles.	4 min	4
18	Lake Beast	Hunt down the Lake Beast and collect its blood	5 min	6
19	Ritual Items	Collect ritual items from forest	2 min	2

20	Vision	Watch a magical vision showing the ruins and the archbishop	3 min	4
21	Corruption	Seek out the ruins and watch corrupt knights convene. Investigate the contraption and enter the Archive	6 min	2
22	Records	Investigate the archive. Read the payment records and King Ignatius's seal	6 min	3
23	Temple	Exit where you came from and fight your way out the ruins OR Exit through the other exit bringing you to the Temple's graveyard	6 min	6
24	Innocence	Return to the leader of the Black Hounds and present your findings.	2 min	3
25	Alliance	Present him the gathered funds, hiring them officially to protect the coronation.	2 min	3
26	Phase 1	Defend the people from unleashed beasts and corrupt knights	6 min	4
27	Phase 2	Fight Lord Varrick one-on-one	5 min	6
28	Phase 3	Watch Lord Varrick sacrifice the archbishop to reveal a demonic form. Defeat him	7 min	7
29	Ending	Ending cutscene of resolution based on actions taken in game	4 min	3

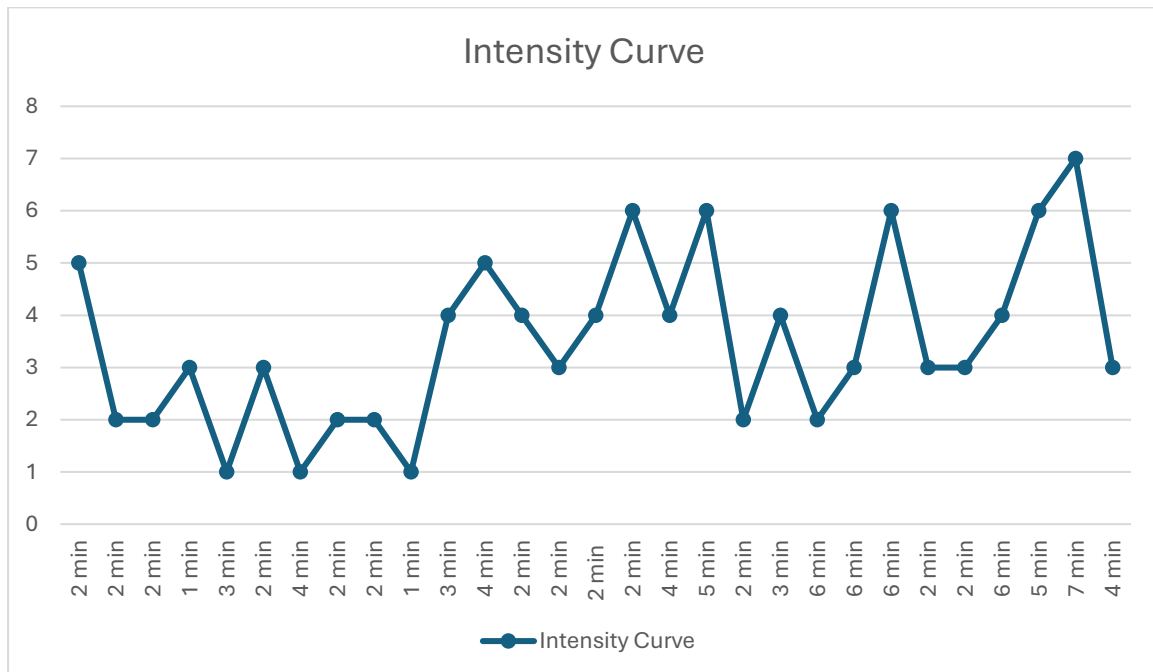
Key Interaction Events:



Resource Distribution:

Story Milestone	Threads Awarded	Total Threads
Squire's Evidence	8000	8000
The Cover-Up	14400	22400
Connections	25920	48320
Infiltrating The Dregs	46656	94976
Arrow's Source	105,024	200000
Magical Origins	100000	300000
Conspiracy Evidence	300000	600000
Alliance	150000	750000
Demon Slayer	250000	1000000

Intensity Curve:



QUEST START:

You stand in the castle courtyards, going about your day.

Your squire arrives injured and frantic.

"My lord... I found them. A guild... The D.... Princess- "

An arrow pierces him mid-sentence and he dies in your arms.

Your eyes dart around the vicinity but find no trace of the assassin.

The guards arrive too late.

You notify the Princess Elvira privately about the situation.

She tells you to handle this alone.

"Even among the guards," she said quietly. "Trust no one."

I frowned.

"You believe the assassin had help?"

"I believe Father did not simply die in his sleep."

"Someone murdered him," she whispered. "And whoever it was is still here."

I wanted to reassure her, but instead, I nodded.

I feared she was right.

PART 1: THE SQUIRE

Time: 0:00 - 6:00

Location: Castle Courtyard

Objective: Investigate the assassination of your squire.

Gameplay:

- Inspect body
- Inspect arrow
- Inspect letter fragment
- Inspect Black Hounds doubloon
- Examine surrounding area
- Identify possible sniper positions

Evidence Obtained:

- Mercenary-grade arrow
- Black Hounds doubloon
- Letter fragment mentioning a guild
- Evidence that the squire was pursued before reaching the castle

Threads Reward: +8000

Next Objective: Investigate castle to find leads.

PART 2: OFFICIAL INVESTIGATION

Time: 6:00 - 12:00

Location: Castle

Objective: Gather witness statements.

Gameplay:

- Question guards
- Question servants
- Question nobles
- Compare conflicting statements

Evidence Obtained:

- No confirmed suspect
- Multiple contradictory testimonies
- Suspicion that information is being concealed

Threads Reward: +14400

Current Total: 22400

Next Objective: Investigate mercenary guilds in Merchant's Row.

PART 3: MERCHANT'S ROW

Time: 12:00 - 20:00

Location: Merchant's Row

Objective: Identify guilds connected to the arrow.

Gameplay:

- Visit The Golden Balance (Guild A)
- Visit The Aegis Exchange (Guild B)
- Dialogue investigations
- Observe mercenary conversations
- Optional bribery interactions

Evidence Obtained:

- Multiple references to Black Hounds
- Guilds refuse cooperation with Crown officials
- Information peddler suggests searching The Dregs

Threads Reward: +25920

Current Total: 48320

Next Objective: Go undercover to The Dregs.

PART 4: INTO THE DREGS

Time: 20:00 - 28:00

Location: The Dregs

Objective: Gather intelligence on Black Hounds.

Gameplay:

- Remove knight equipment
- Enter tavern district
- Eavesdrop on conversations
- Avoid attracting suspicion
- Optional combat encounter if discovered

Evidence Obtained:

- Coronation repeatedly mentioned
- Black Hounds name appears frequently
- Confirmation that a conspiracy exists

Threads Reward: +46656

Current Total: 94976

Next Objective: Locate Black Hounds headquarters.

PART 5: THE BLACKHOUNDS

Time: 28:00 - 36:00

Location: The Dregs (Black Hounds Headquarters)

Objective: Infiltrate the guild to find the source of the arrow.

Gameplay:

- Stealth navigation into the guild building
- Eavesdrop on fragments ("Royal contract," "Nobility")
- Investigate the guild armoury
- Talk to the receptionist regarding magic sigils and the witch. She is uncooperative.
 - Bribe her
 - Threaten her
- Combat sequence (Guild members alerted to infiltrator)

Evidence Obtained:

- Identical arrow to the one that killed the squire, but with no magical sigils
- Location of the Witch extracted from the receptionist

Threads Reward: +105024

Current Total: 200000

Next Objective: Find the Witch to examine the arrow.

PART 6: THE WITCH

Time: 36:00 - 50:00

Location: Whispering Woods / The Lake

Objective: Enlist the witch's help to learn the arrow's true nature.

Gameplay:

- Travel through the forest
- Solve environmental puzzles to proceed
- Hunt down the beast in the nearby lake (Boss sequence)
- Bring the beast's blood to the Witch
- Collect ritual items for her vision

Evidence Obtained:

- The Witch reveals the inscribed sigils are NOT witchcraft
- Markings are identified as -sanctioned Inquisitor sigils used for enchanted weapons
- The knight questions the 's involvement
- A magical vision reveals the location of forgotten ruins

Story driver:

- The Temple has always been cordial to the royal family, are they being framed?
- The Temple always preached about the evils of magic. Surely the arrow wasn't theirs.

Threads Reward: +100000

Current Total: 300000

Next Objective: Explore the forgotten ruins to uncover the Temple's secrets.

PART 7: SECRETS

Time: 50:00 - 66:00

Location: The Forgotten Ruins / Archive

Objective: Uncover the conspiracy within the ruins.

Gameplay:

- Observe corrupt knights tinkering with a contraption
- Solve contraption puzzle to reveal the hidden doorway
- Investigate the archive
- Combat sequence (Ambushed by corrupt knights upon exiting)

Evidence Obtained:

- Payment records stretching back months, signed by Lord Varrick
- Letters confirming an alliance between Varrick and the Temple
- A royal authorization bearing King Ignatius's seal

Story driver: The king had begun his own investigation into the Temple and nobility. He died because he uncovered it.

Threads Reward: +300000

Current Total: 600000

Next Objective: Gather allies

PART 8: AN UNLIKELY ALLIANCE

Time: 66:00 - 70:00

Location: The Dregs (Black Hounds Headquarters)

Objective: Clear the Black Hounds' name and hire them for the coronation.

Gameplay:

- Return to the Black Hounds guild house
- Present the archive evidence proving they are being framed
- Present gathered funds to enlist their help

Evidence Obtained:

- The arrow mystery is fully resolved
- The Black Hounds are secured as allies to protect the fleeing citizens and the Princess

Threads Reward: +150000

Current Total: 750000

Next Objective: Protect Princess Elvira at her coronation.

PART 9: THE CORONATION

Time: 70:00 - 90:00

Location: The Cathedral Steps/Grand Plaza

Objective: Defend Princess Elvira and defeat the conspirators.

Gameplay:

Speak privately with Princess Elvira. Inform her of the situation and the plan.

Coronation ceremony starts:

- **Phase 1:** Beasts are released into the crowds
 - Protect the fleeing citizens
 - Defeat the beasts
 - Protect Elvira from Clerics and Corrupt Knights.
- **Phase 2:** Lord Varrick
 - One-on-one sword combat.
- **Phase 3:** Archbishop Sacrifice
 - Lord Varrick sacrifices the archbishop, activating a curse, transforming into a demonic vessel of corruption.
 - Defeat the Varrick the Vessel of Corruption. (Final Boss)

Evidence Obtained:

- The Temple is exposed for their hypocrisy towards magic to the realm.
- Lord Varrick and The Temple were co-conspirators
- Dabbling in black magic

Ending:

- Elvira ascends the throne as Queen.
- Varrick's nobility line is destroyed.
- The Temple, knights and nobles are thoroughly investigated, weeding out traitors.
- The Black Hounds rewarded for their help and established as a formal guild, backed by the Royal Family

Threads Reward: +250000

Current Total: 1000000